

Publication: "Terrorism and the Cold War in Thomas Pynchon's *Against the Day* and Don DeLillo's *Underworld*"

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This piece explores the conceptions of terrorism in two novels that stand separated by the calamitous events of September 11th, 2001: Pynchon's *Against the Day* and Don DeLillo's *Underworld*, with special focus upon the genesis of these depictions in Cold War politics and notions of capitalist statehood. While there are cases to be made for many geographico-historical connections in these works, both these novels frame the Cold War as a locus of economics, religion and terror that is to be found at few other points.

This piece also stages a direct engagement with Kathryn Hume's article, "The Religious and Political Vision of Pynchon's *Against the Day*," which suggested an overt "seriousness" in which a "more aggressive" Pynchon "appears to support political violence"; terrorism (Hume 164). Here I will present the cumulative textual evidence that complicates such a stance through the fact that – in the thematic matrix of the Cold War which grounds this theme – the religious, the political and the terroristic cannot be cleanly separated.

Eve, Martin Paul, "["It Sure's Hell Looked Like War": Terrorism and the Cold War in Thomas Pynchon's *Against the Day* and Don DeLillo's *Underworld*](#)", in Thomas Pynchon and the (De)vices of Global (Post)modernity, ed. by Zofia Kolbuszewska (Lublin: Wydawnictwo KUL, 2013)